THE ADVENTURES OF FARMERCINDY

Strawberry Sprout & Seed Journal

A 12-Part Illustrated Hands-On Growing Guide for Young Gardeners (Ages 3-9)

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Author: Cindy Marie Clarke-Jones (Farmer Cindy)
Illustrator: Sanii Arts
Organization: FarmerCindy, Inc. 501(c)(3) Non-Profit

Activity 1: Anatomy of a Strawberry Plant

Every plant has special parts that help it drink water, capture sunshine, and make sweet fruit! Trace and label each part below:

Plant Part	What It Does	Your Field Notes
1. Roots	Drink water and nutrients deep from soil.	[ ] Seen under soil
2. Crown	The heart of the plant right at soil level.	[ ] Kept above dirt
3. Runner (Stolon)	Reaches out across the soil to plant a baby clone!	[ ] Searching for sun
4. Leaves	Catch sunlight and make sugar food (Photosynthesis).	[ ] 3 serrated leaflets
5. White Flower	Welcomes friendly bees to pollinate the blossom.	[ ] 5 white petals
6. Strawberry Fruit	The only fruit wearing 200 tiny seeds on its skin!	[ ] Turning bright red!

Fun Farmer Fact: Did you know strawberries belong to the Rose family (Rosaceae)? They love morning sunshine and singing gentle songs while you water them!

Activity 2: How to Grow on a Windowsill

You don't need a 50-acre farm to be a farmer! Cindy started on a sunny windowsill in an apartment. Here is your 4-step mission:

Step 1: Choose Your Pot	Find a small container with drainage holes at the bottom. An upcycled yogurt cup or egg carton worl
Step 2: Plant Gently	Press your heirloom strawberry seeds 1/4 inch deep into the soil. Cover lightly with dirt like tucking t
Step 3: Sip, Don't Soak	Use a gentle spray bottle to mist the soil until moist. Never drown the seeds! Keep the soil damp like
Step 4: Chase Sunshine	Place your pot on a sunny south-facing windowsill where it gets at least 6 hours of happy daylight e

Activity 3: 30-Day Sprout Observation Log

Real agricultural scientists keep field journals! Draw or write what you observe each week as your seeds awaken:

Week	Date	Watered?	Sunlight (Hours)	Sprout Height	Sketch / Observations
Week 1		[ ] Yes		____ cm	Draw what your seedling looks like:
Week 2		[ ] Yes		____ cm	Draw what your seedling looks like:
Week 3		[ ] Yes		____ cm	Draw what your seedling looks like:
Week 4		[ ] Yes		____ cm	Draw what your seedling looks like:

Activity 4: Soil Protectors & Pollinator Friends

In Book 2 (*What's Happening to Our Farming Community?*), Cindy learns that healthy soil and pollinators are the superheroes of agriculture. Match each farm friend to their superpower!

Super Farm Friend	Their Hidden Superpower	How to Protect Them
Honeybee & Bumblebee	Visits 2,000 flowers a day to carry pollen so fruit can form.	Plant colorful flowers and avoid chemical pesticides.
Earthworm (Wiggly)	Tunnels underground to aerate soil and makes organic fertilizer.	Add compost, fallen leaves, and keep soil damp.
Ladybug	Munches on tiny aphids that try to eat fresh strawberry leaves.	Never squish them! They are garden defenders.
Sun & Rain Clouds	Powers plant energy and quenches thirsty roots.	Collect rainwater in a garden barrel.

OFFICIAL JUNIOR SPROUTER CERTIFICATE

This certifies that

_____

_____

has completed the *Farmer Cindy Strawberry Sprout & Seed Journal*, demonstrating excellence in caring for heirloom seeds, respecting pollinators, and planting seeds of nutrition in their home and community!

Farmer Cindy Marie Clarke-Jones **Date Awarded: _____**

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